County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, January 12, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/371736

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:00 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Chair Howard led the Pledge of Allegiance and Rev. Bryson Williams gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the minutes from Caucus and Council on December 8, 2025.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

6. Administrators Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/371736

a. Quarterly Economic Development Update

b. Discussion of Funding to re-implement the Discounted Impact Fee Schedule for Qualified Affordable Housing.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Dawson to put the item on the floor for discussion.

7. Public Comment Period

Public Comments were taken.

8. Liaison and Committee Reports

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
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Motion: It was moved by Council Member McElynn, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew that County Council direct the Administrator to have his staff work with Beaufort Jasper Housing Trust Organization to develop proposals for Council to consider related to any changes we make to better assist with making affordable and workforce housing more readily available in unincorporated county areas.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Reitz to remand the ordinance back to the Natural Resource Committee.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 7:4.

9. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2025/51: An ordinance to amend Beaufort County’s Ordinance Chapter 102 Waterways article IV, abandoned and derelict boats, section 102-171 through 102-183.**(PUBLIC HEARING)**

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on October 20, 2025 - 9:0
The vote at First Reading on November 10, 2025 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading on December 8, 2025 - 9:0
The waterways ordinance amendment came forward to the Public Facilities Committee on September 15, 2025. The committee motioned and approved to send this item to the next Public Facilities Committee meeting to allow additional public engagement. The item came forward again at the Public Facilities meeting on October 20, 2025. The committee motioned and approved, bifurcating the ordinance amendment to send charges to articles I, II, and III back for staff review and re-submission, and approved sending amendments to the ordinance for inclusion of Article IV forward to county council for first reading.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve third reading and public hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/51.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. 2025/52: An Ordinance recommending approval of the 2% State Accommodations Tax Awards as presented by the State Atax Committee. **(PUBLIC HEARING)**

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on October 20, 2025 - 7:0.
The vote at First Reading on November 10, 2025 - 11:0.
The vote at Second Reading on December 8, 2025 - 9:0
N/A

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Dawson, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve third reading and public hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/52.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 10:1.

10. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2025/53: An Ordinance Authorizing the Acceptance and Possible Eminent Domain Associated with a Drainage Easement located in Rivers End Subdivision Identified as Open Area in Plat Book 59 at page 118. **(PUBLIC HEARING)**

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on November 17, 2025 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on December 8, 2025 - 9:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve second reading and public hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/53.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

11. Ordinances for First Reading

a. 2026/01: An Ordinance amending the Zoning Map for 231.58 Acres (R100 025 000 0084 0000, R100 025 000 0110 0000, R100 020 000 047A 0000, R100 026 00A 0260 0000, R100 026 00A 0261 0000, R300 028 000 0016 0000, R300 028 000 016A 0000, R300 015 000 076B 0000, R100 033 00A 0022 0000, R600 009 000 0030 0000, R600 013 000 0048 0000, R600 009 000 0003 0000, R600 005 000 004D 0000, R600 021 000 0078 0000, R600 029 000 0054 0000, R600 021 000 0819 0000) from S1, T2R, T3HN, T4HC, C4CCMU, and C5RCMU to T1NP. **(PUBLIC HEARING)**

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on November 3, 2025 - 6:2

Motion: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve first reading and public hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/01 for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals and policies of the comprehensive code and the purposes of the development code; it is not in conflict with provisions of the development code and or out code of ordinances; it does address a demonstrated community need; it is required by changed conditions; it is compatible with existing and proposed use of land surrounding this land; it would not adversely affect nearby land; it would result in logical and orderly development patterns; it would not result in adverse impact on the natural environment (water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment); and it would result in development that is adequately served by public facilities (streets, potable water, sewer, stormwater management, solid waste collection and disposal, schools, parks, police, fire, emergency medical facilities).

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham and Council Member Lawson. The motion passed 7:4.

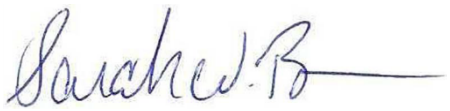
12. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY



BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:



_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: January 26, 2026